

World History





About the Course

Through the reading of history stories and biographies, students experience what life was like in different times and places. They are exposed to the everyday experiences as well as the major events from our current history cycle (1800-1900). Students will also view images, reference maps, and work on their century charts and Book of Centuries as part of their lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grade 4 (U.S.), History: Grade 4 (Canada), History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	World History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter Under the Hawthorn Tree Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grade 4 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 2-4		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

World History: Grades 4-6



William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter



Under the Hawthorn Tree



Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



World History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 1

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

1. When you think of Ireland, what comes to mind? Perhaps the story of St. Patrick. Ireland is often called the Emerald Isle because of its lush greenery. It is considered an enchanting place to visit.
∞ Image Link: The Cliffs of Moher

1. However, in the 1840s tragedy struck Ireland that changed it forever. There was a terrible famine and many people either died or left the country to go to America. Today one-sixth of US citizens (43 million) identify their national background as Irish. How did this famine occur and what was it like to live in Ireland at this time? This book is a fictional account of an Irish family during that time and what they did to survive. The author is from Ireland and has sequels to this book if you want to read more.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1- beginning of ch.2 p.1-11 "The air felt" - "they reached home."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2- Beginning of ch. 3 p. 11-20 "The big basket" - "her brave brother."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.3 and begin ch.4, p.20-30 "The sky had" - "of the blankets."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.4 and begin ch. 5, p.30-41 "All the next" - "to keep hidden."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 1

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.5 and begin ch.6, p.41-51 "Eily, Eily" - "happened to them."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-61 "By next morning"

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-71,

→ VIEW

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-86

→ VIEW

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-97

→ VIEW

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 1	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.97-105 → VIEW	
WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.107-119 → VIEW	
WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM:UNDER THE HAWTHORN TREE	

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 2

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.9-17

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link:

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**
What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.18-26

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link:

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**
What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.27-36

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link:

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**
What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.37-46

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link:

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**
What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.47-56

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link:

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.57-66

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-76

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-86

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-95

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-103

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter →RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.105-114 → VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: WILLIAM WILBERFORCE: THE FREEDOM FIGHTER	

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Aliens Arrive

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→INTRO

This is a non-fiction book that tells the story of how U.S. Navy ships headed by Commodore Matthew Perry ships sailed to Japan in 1853 to bring a letter from President Fillmore asking Japan to open their ports to trading with the U.S. Other attempts had been tried before but were unsuccessful. Due to policies in Japan, they had remained isolated from most other countries for hundreds of years. Imagine you are living in your small fishing village of Shimoda and had never met anyone from another country. You see four huge ships approaching. That is what it was like for the people on that day in July 8, 1853. Let's first learn about the geography of Japan.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.30-31, 92-92

- 1.On which continent is Japan found? (Asia)
- 2.How would you get from the U.S. to Japan in a ship if you were going to leave from the east coast? (Sail east across the Atlantic Ocean, around the southern tip of Africa, and across the Indian Ocean and western Pacific in between Sumatra and Malaysia).
- 3.Which countries are closest to Japan? (North and South Korea, Russia, China)
- 4.Is Japan north or south of the equator? (north)
- 5.What is the capital of Japan? (Tokyo)
- 6.Turn to p.91-92. How many main islands is Japan made up of? (4) Name them. (Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, Kyushu) There are also nearly 4,000 smaller islands!
- 7.Which island is the largest? (Honshu)
- 8.What bodies of water surround Japan? (the Pacific Ocean, Sea of Japan / East Sea, East China Sea, Sea of Okhotsk)
- 9.What physical features cover much of Japan? (Almost four-fifths of Japan is covered with mountains.)
- 10.Why might Japan's island location have helped protect it from invasions?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-start of Ch.2 p.13-20 Beginning-"ship to leave."

- Why do you think the title of the first chapter is "Aliens Arrive"?
- Why might they think American ships are not coming on friendly terms?

→ VIEW

- 1.∞ Image Links: Chart of Feudal System & Japanese Society
Japan was still based on a feudal society which means society was divided into strict social classes where everyone had a specific role that had to follow. Read the description of Japanese society and look at the chart that shows the feudal system and who has the most power and the least power.
- 2.Look at the illustrations at the beginning of the book and in ch.1 Then read about the illustrations on p.138. Most of the illustrations come that time period from either Japanese artists or American artists that were part of the expedition.

• DEFINITIONS

turmoil: a state or condition of extreme confusion (p.14)

inept:(p.15) lacking qualities (as knowledge, skill, or ability) required to do a job

• EXTRA HELPING

The Japanese had never seen a steamship. If you are interested to learn more about steamships watch this video.

∞ **Video Link:** The Story of Steamships (2:55-5:00)

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 3

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

The Black Ships of Evil Men; His High and Mighty Mysteriousness

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The four Americans ships full of 560 men of the U.S. Navy have arrived off the coast of Japan and now we will find out how the Japanese will respond. What do you think they will do?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2-ch.3 p.20-29

- Why do you think Commodore Perry stood firm on his decision to not sail to the port in Nagasaki or meet with lower officials? (Interesting note: It was said that Perry realized that previous failures had resulted from insufficient show of strength and ignorance of Japanese character, two mistakes he would never make.)
- What are the some of the differences you notice so far between the Americans and Japanese?

moored: anchored (p.20)

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Landing on Sacred Soil

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.4 p.30-36

- What stood out to you about the meeting?
- 2.Read the letter from President Fillmore that is found in Appendix A, p.123-124
- Do you think the letter was persuasive? What do you think about the reasons he gave for opening trade?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustration on p.32-33 and details you remember from the reading.

• DEFINITIONS

cutlass: a short curving sword formerly used by sailors on warships (p.31)

pikemen: soldier with a heavy spear with a very long shaft (p.31)

anteroom: a small outer room that leads to another room and that is often used as a waiting room (p.34)

capacious: wide or huge (p.36)

abrogate: to put an end to by formal action (p.124)

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

The Dutch Island Prison, Foreigners Forbidden

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The only Western country that had been allowed to trade with Japan was the Netherlands which began trade in 1608. The Dutch traders were confined to an artificial island and had many rules to follow. You will read about that in this chapter. Then the next chapter will explain why the Japanese were cut off from the rest of the world and how it had not always been that way.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Japan

Find Nagasaki in the western side of Japan. The tiny island of Deshima

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last sentence on p.39 that tells about the actions of the Dutchmen before the Shoguns.



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was connected by bridge to Nagasaki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.5 p.37-40

- Why do you think the Dutch put up with all those rules and requirements in order to have a trading station?

2.Ch.6 p.41-43

- Why do you think the Japanese mistrusted foreigners?

→ VIEW

This illustration from the Phillip von Siebold's book shows Deshima, the artificial island where the Dutch traders lived.

∞ Image Link: Illustration of Deshima.

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

The Great Peace

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In this chapter you will learn more about the Japanese feudal system where everyone was born into a specific social class. You may want to write the names of the classes on a whiteboard or piece of paper as you read about them and put symbols or words that represent their roles and obligations.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.44-53

- What do you think the basis was for all the specific rules they had?
- How do you determine what rules a society should have and what rules take away personal freedom?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the reference to ritual suicide on p.48.

• DEFINITIONS

vassal: (p.47) a person who received protection and land from a lord in return for loyalty and service

saki: a Japanese alcoholic drink that is made from rice (p.52)

stratified: divided into social classes (p.53)

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Clouds Over the Land of the Rising Sun, The Black Ships Return

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Student World Atlas, p.93

Find Hong Kong. (southeastern China) Commodore Perry and his men went to Hong Kong while they waited for the Japanese leaders to make their decision.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.8 p.54-59

- What do you think about some of the American customs that Manjiro found strange?
- 2.Begin Ch.9 63-65 Beginning-"to read documents."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the first paragraph on p.63 that talks about women and liquor and minstrel shows.

• DEFINITIONS

armaments: weapons (p.56)

quandary: a situation in which you are confused about what to do (p.57)

monotony: (p.65) a lack of change that makes something boring

World History: Grades 4-6

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WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

The Black Ships Return, The Treaty House

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.65-68 "During the long" - end of chapter.

2. Ch.10 p.69-77

- Perry didn't think the Japanese valued human life because of their treatment of the American sailors and some of the Japanese customs. What would it look like if a society valued human life?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustrations on p.70-73 and details you remember from the reading.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is mention of ritual suicides on p.76 in the last two paragraphs.

• DEFINITIONS

retainers: servants (p.69)

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

An Array of Gifts

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How do you feel when people give you gifts? Perry thought he would try to win over the Japanese by giving them all kinds of gifts that would be represent America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 11 p.78-86

- Which gift of the Americans do you think was the most interesting?
- Which gift of the Japanese do you think was the most interesting?

→ VIEW

1. If you are interested, look at the list of gifts in Appendix C & D, p.127-130

2. The Japanese gave the Americans pieces of lacquerware. Lacquer, a shiny, hard surface is applied to materials such as wood or metal. Then pictures are painted on the objects.

∞ Image Link: Writing lacquer box

• EXTRA HELPING

One of the gifts the Americans brought to Japan was a telegraph. Watch this short video to learn about this invention.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

The Grand Banquet, The Treaty

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 12-13 p.87-96

- Are you surprised by the concessions the Japanese made in the treaty?
- Why do you think they were now open to engaging with foreigners?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview content on p.91 that talks about a minstrel show.

• DEFINITIONS

diplomacy: the work of maintaining good relations between the governments of different countries (p.87)

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 3

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Excursions on Land and Sea, Shore Leave

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

1.∞ Map Link: Shimoda, Japan

You will see that Shimoda is darkened on this map. This is one of the ports that the Americans are allowed to use. This is also the fishing village that was mentioned at the beginning of the book that first sighted the 4 black ships.

2.∞ Map Link: Hakodate, Japan

Hakodate is circled on the map. Where is it located in relation to Shimoda? This is the other port city that the Americans were allowed to go to.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 14-15 p.97-106

- What were some of the differences between the American customs and lifestyle and the Japanese?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview bottom of p.98 and top of p.99 that again mentions ritual suicide. P.102 talks about a bathhouse that is shared by both men and women.

• DEFINITIONS

daguerreotype: an early photograph produced on a silver or a silver-covered copper plate (p.103)

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

In the Wake of the Black Ships

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 16, Afterward

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: COMMODORE PERRY IN THE LAND OF THE SHOGUN